

CA03

National Affairs: Polity, Governance and Schemes

Roughly 6-8 questions inside the ~21-question current affairs block, plus a spillover into Indian Polity. Content window September 2025 to September 2026, stated as of September 2026.

The national half of the current affairs block — who holds which office, what Parliament passed, what the Supreme Court held, which scheme got money and where India stands in the global index tables. In 2025-26 this chapter carries an unusually heavy load, because two things happened that RAS-type papers cannot ignore: MGNREGA was repealed and replaced, and the Supreme Court's sanctioned strength went up.

National Affairs (Sept 2025 - Sept 2026)

Who is who

- CJI Surya Kant (53rd)
- CEC Gyanesh Kumar
- CAG K. Sanjay Murthy
- RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra

Supreme Court

- Adoptive mothers - 12 weeks leave
- SC status limited to Hindu/Sikh/Buddhist
- Aravalli 100 m criterion suspended

Big laws

- VB-G RAM G Act 2025 replaces MGNREGA
- Nuclear Energy Act 2025
- SC (Number of Judges) Amendment 2026 - 34 to 38
- Jan Vishwas 2026 - 80 Acts

Schemes

- BHAVYA Rasayan - chemical parks
- GOBARdhan - compressed biogas
- Jal Jeevan Mission to Dec 2028
- PMGSY-III to Mar 2028

Constitution & census

- 131st Amendment Bill DEFEATED 16 Apr 2026
- Delimitation and women's reservation
- Census 2027 - first digital census
- Caste enumeration in Phase II

Elections & indices

- Counting 4 May 2026 - WB, TN, Kerala, Assam, Puducherry
- Happiness 116th
- HDI 130th
- GII 38th

Who holds which office — learn this as a table, revise it weekly

Every paper has one or two 'who is the present X' questions, and they are free marks if you keep a table. Two rules. One, learn the office WITH its constitutional or statutory basis — RPSC often asks the article rather than the name. Two, treat every name here as dated: all positions below are as of September 2026, and offices change with retirements.

Constitutional and high offices (as of September 2026)

Office	Incumbent	Basis
President of India	Droupadi Murmu	Article 52-62
Vice-President of India	C.P. Radhakrishnan	Ex officio Chairman, Rajya Sabha (Art. 64)
Chief Justice of India	Justice Surya Kant (53rd CJI)	Article 124
Chief Election Commissioner	Gyanesh Kumar	Article 324; CEC and ECs Act, 2023
Comptroller and Auditor General	K. Sanjay Murthy	Article 148
Speaker, Lok Sabha	Om Birla	Article 93
Chairman, UPSC	Ajay Kumar	Article 315
Chairperson, NHRC	Justice V. Ramasubramanian	Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993

Law officers, economic and scientific heads (as of September 2026)

Office	Incumbent
Attorney General for India	R. Venkataramani
Solicitor General of India	Tushar Mehta
Cabinet Secretary	T.V. Somanathan
National Security Adviser	Ajit Doval

Office	Incumbent
Chief Economic Adviser	V. Anantha Nageswaran
Governor, Reserve Bank of India	Sanjay Malhotra
Chairman, SEBI	Tuhin Kanta Pandey
Chairman, ISRO	Dr V. Narayanan

- RBI Deputy Governors include Poonam Gupta and Shirish Chandra Murmu, appointed September 2025 in place of M. Rajeshwar Rao.
- The CEC and Election Commissioners are appointed under the 2023 Act by a committee of the PM, a Union Minister and the Leader of the Opposition.
- The CAG is appointed under Article 148 and can be removed only in the manner of a Supreme Court judge.

ASKED IN RAS

RESEARCH clusters 17 and 22: the CAG's appointment and removal articles were asked in 2018, 2021 and 2023; the Election Commission in 2023 and 2024; the CVC in 2018 and 2024. The current-affairs version of this is the incumbent's name. Learn name + article together and you cover both papers.

CURRENT LINK

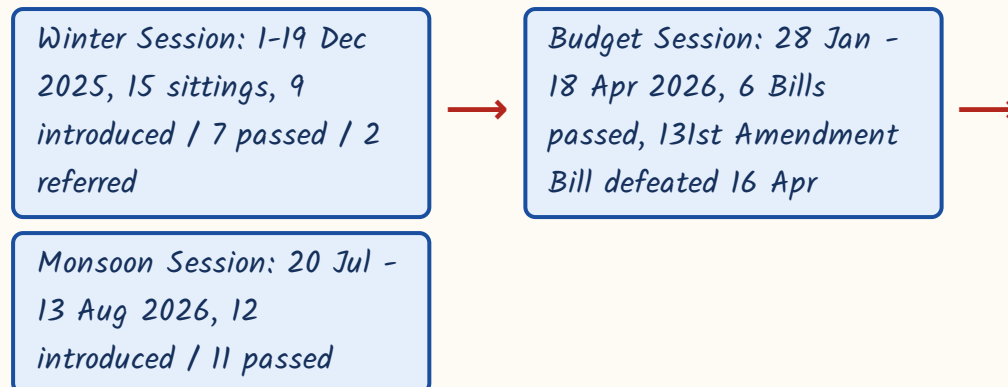
Most volatile part of this chapter, as of September 2026: office-holders. The CJI, the CEC, service chiefs and commission chairpersons can all change before 6 December 2026. Re-verify this table in November 2026 and change nothing else.

The three sessions of Parliament — the skeleton of the year

Hang everything legislative on three pegs: Winter 2025, Budget 2026 and Monsoon 2026. If you know which law belongs to which session, chronology

questions and 'which was NOT passed' questions both collapse.

The legislative year at a glance



- Winter 2025: the two Bills referred to committees were the Securities Markets Code, 2025 and the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan Bill, 2025.
- Monsoon 2026 productivity was poor — the Lok Sabha functioned about 15 per cent and the Rajya Sabha about 33 per cent of scheduled time.
- Monsoon 2026: the Indian Statistical Institute Bill, 2026 was introduced and referred to a standing committee — it was NOT passed.

Winter Session 2025 — MGNREGA replaced, and the other laws

This is the change you must be able to state in one clean sentence. The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 was repealed and replaced by the Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025 — short form VB-G RAM G. It was introduced in the Lok Sabha on 16 December 2025, passed by both Houses on 18 December 2025, and received the President's assent on 21 December 2025.

MGNREGA, 2005 vs VB-G RAM G Act, 2025

MGNREGA, 2005	VB-G RAM G Act, 2025
100 days of guaranteed wage employment per rural household per year	125 days guaranteed
Centre bore the bulk of wage cost, states a smaller share	Centrally sponsored on a 60:40 basis (Centre:State) for general states
Uniform pattern across states	90:10 for North-Eastern and Himalayan states
Programme run as an employment guarantee scheme	Run as a Mission, with national and state steering committees
No statutory pause for the farm season	States must notify up to 60 days a year when works pause for peak agriculture

- The statutory right to work survives — it is enlarged to 125 days, not abolished.
- Unemployment allowance is retained: the state must pay if work is not given within 15 days of demand.
- Gram panchayat planning is organised around four themes — water security, rural infrastructure, livelihood support and mitigation of extreme weather.
- Delivery uses biometric authentication, geospatial mapping, mobile dashboards and weekly public disclosure.

TRAP

Three numbers RPSC will play with: it is 125 days (not 100, not 150), the funding is 60:40 (not 75:25, not 90:10 for general states), and the assent date is 21 December 2025. And a statement saying the Act 'abolished the statutory right to work' is FALSE.

Four more laws from the same session are examinable, and each is a one-line fact. Learn what each one replaced or changed — that is the shape of the question.

- *Nuclear Energy Act, 2025* — replaced the Atomic Energy Act, 1962 and permits private-sector participation in nuclear power generation and fuel handling.
- *Insurance Laws (Amendment), 2025* — FDI in insurance raised to 100 per cent; net-owned-fund requirement for foreign re-insurers cut from Rs 5,000 crore to Rs 1,000 crore.
- *Repealing and Amending Act, 2025* — repealed 71 obsolete laws.
- *Securities Markets Code, 2025* (referred to committee) — would consolidate the SEBI Act, the Depositories Act and the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Act.
- *Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan Bill, 2025* (referred to committee) — a single higher-education regulator replacing the UGC, AICTE and NCTE.

TRAP

The Nuclear Energy Act, 2025 replaced the ATOMIC ENERGY ACT, 1962 — not the Electricity Act, 2003. A distractor option offering the Electricity Act appeared in the practice set and it is exactly what a paper-setter writes.

Budget Session and Monsoon Session 2026 — the new statute book

Six Bills were passed in the Budget Session and eleven in the Monsoon Session. You do not need all seventeen. You need the ones with a distinctive subject, because matching questions pair the Bill's name with what it does.

Budget Session 2026 — the six laws

Law	What it does
Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions), 2026	Decriminalises or rationalises offences across 80 central Acts

Law	What it does
Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration), 2026	50% of IG posts and 67% of ADG posts by IPS deputation
Industrial Relations Code (Amendment)	Labour law amendment
Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Amendment	Rights of transgender persons
Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (Amendment)	Insolvency process
Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation (Amendment)	Reorganisation provisions

Monsoon Session 2026 — the laws that carry a fact

Law	Key point
Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment, 2026	Sanctioned strength raised from 34 to 38
Tribunals Reforms, 2026	Establishes a National Tribunals Commission
Kerala (Alteration of Name), 2026	Renames the state 'Keralam'
Bankers' Books Evidence, 2026	Digital banking records admissible as legal evidence
MSME Development (Amendment), 2026	Mediation in delayed-payment disputes within 90 days
Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment	Exam-integrity law tightened
Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment)	National honour offences
Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment)	Civil registration
MMDR (Amendment), 2026	Centre's power over mineral-bearing lands
Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) / NCDC (Amendment)	Tax and co-operative development

Take the first row seriously. The Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Act, 1956 fixed the number of judges other than the Chief Justice; the 2026 Amendment changed that figure from 33 to 37, which means a total sanctioned strength of 38 including the CJI. An ordinance came first, on 17 May 2026; the Lok Sabha cleared the Bill on 3 August 2026 and the President assented on 12 August 2026. The reason given was case load and the diversion of judges to Constitution Benches. The previous increase was in 2019, from 31 to 34 in total.

TRAP

38 is the TOTAL including the Chief Justice of India; the Act's own wording says 37 other judges. Also remember a state's name is altered under Article 3 by an ordinary law passed by simple majority — Kerala becoming 'Keralam' is not a constitutional amendment.

Constitutional developments — delimitation, women's reservation and the Census

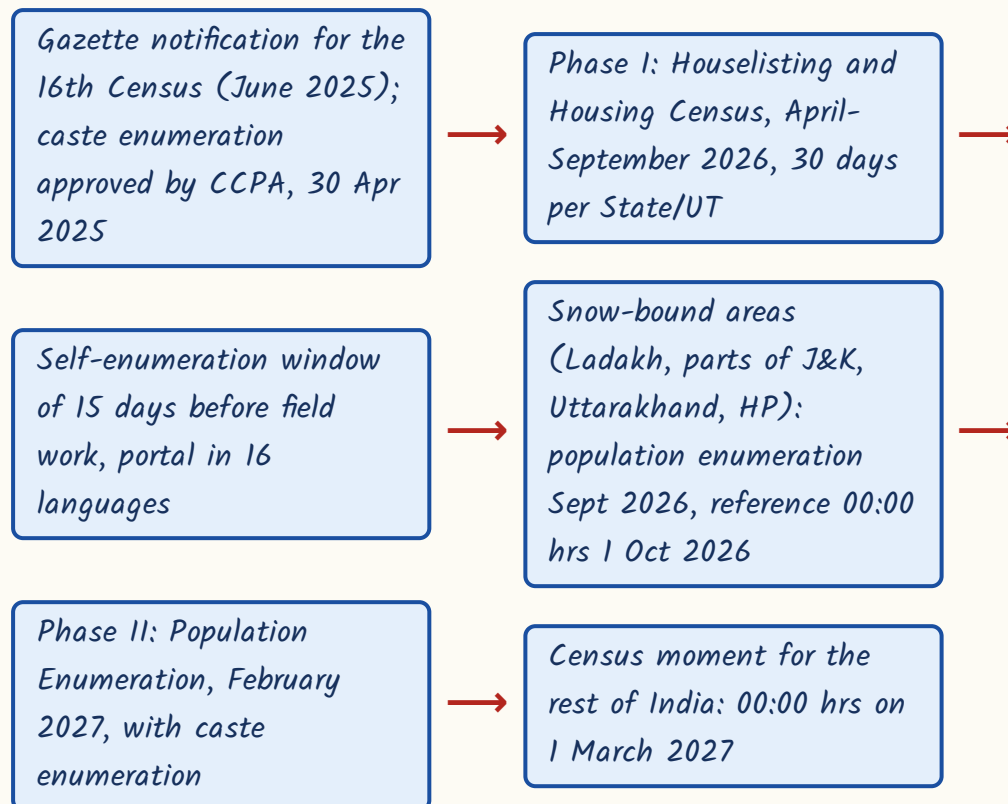
The headline constitutional event of 2026 is a negative one, and negatives are exactly what RPSC likes. The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 dealt with delimitation. It proposed raising the maximum strength of the Lok Sabha from 550 to 850, carrying out delimitation on the basis of the Census of 2011, and commencing women's reservation. It was VOTED DOWN on 16 April 2026. So there is no 131st Amendment on the statute book — a constitutional amendment needs a special majority in each House, and this one did not get it. Any statement that it was 'passed in April 2026' is false, and that is precisely the statement RPSC will put in front of you.

- Background: Article 82 requires readjustment after every census; the 84th Amendment, 2001 froze seat numbers until the first census taken after

2026.

- The 106th Amendment, 2023 gave women one-third reservation in the Lok Sabha and state assemblies, but its commencement is tied to a census and the delimitation that follows.
- That is why the Census of 2027 is a polity question, not only a statistics question.

Census 2027 — the two phases



- Census 2027 is India's FIRST fully digital census — mobile app for enumerators and an optional self-enumeration portal.
- Budget about Rs 11,718 crore; roughly 31 lakh enumerators and supervisors.
- Rajasthan's Phase I schedule: self-enumeration 1-15 May 2026, door-to-door enumeration 16 May to 14 June 2026 — self-enumeration was a nationwide feature, not a Rajasthan exclusive.

ASKED IN RAS

RESEARCH cluster 20: constitutional amendments matched to their subject are asked in EVERY single paper. For 2026 the two to hold are the 106th (women's reservation, 2023) and the 131st Bill (delimitation, defeated 2026). Know which is an Act and which is only a Bill.

Supreme Court judgments of consequence

Three rulings from this window are worth full sentences, because each of them changes a right or a definition.

- 17 March 2026 — adoptive mothers are entitled to 12 weeks of PAID maternity leave, irrespective of the age of the adopted child.
- 24 March 2026 — Scheduled Caste status is confined to persons professing Hinduism, Sikhism or Buddhism; conversion out of these results in loss of SC status. This follows the Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950.
- 30 December 2025 — the Court suspended the 100-metre height criterion for classifying the Aravallis and ordered a high-level expert committee covering Rajasthan, Haryana and Delhi-NCR.

Notice how each of these attaches to something you already know. The maternity-leave ruling is Article 21 read with service law; the SC-status ruling is the 1950 Presidential Order under Article 341; the Aravalli order is environmental jurisdiction under Article 32 and it directly affects Rajasthan's mining and hill-protection map.

ASKED IN RAS

RESEARCH cluster 23: the judicial expansion of Article 21 and Article 39A were asked in 2018, 2023 and 2024. The March 2026 maternity-leave ruling is the current-affairs face of that same cluster — expect it as either a polity question or a current-affairs one.

CURRENT LINK

As of September 2026 the Aravalli expert committee's definition had not been notified. If it lands before December 2026 it becomes a two-mark item — one national, one Rajasthan. Check in November 2026.

Schemes — new, revamped and extended

Scheme questions are always the same shape: name to sector, or name to outlay. Keep new schemes and extended schemes in two separate lists, because that is how the matching questions are built.

New and revamped schemes, 2026

Scheme	Sector	Outlay and period
BHAVYA Rasayan (Aug 2026)	Three chemical parks	Rs 3,030 crore, 2026-27 to 2030-31
GOBARdhan, revamped (6 Aug 2026)	Compressed biogas	Rs 23,731 crore, 2026-27 to 2035-36
PNG Incentive Scheme (Aug 2026)	Piped natural gas	-

Extensions announced in 2026

Scheme	Extended to	Outlay
PMGSY-III	March 2028	Rs 83,977 crore (revised)

Scheme	Extended to	Outlay
Jal Jeevan Mission	December 2028	About Rs 8.7 lakh crore
UDAN (revamped)	2026-36	Rs 28,840 crore
RoSCTL (textile exports)	September 2026	-

TRAP

Do not swap BHAVYA Rasayan and GOBARDhan. BHAVYA Rasayan = chemical parks (rasayan = chemical, the name tells you). GOBARDhan = compressed biogas from cattle waste (gobar = dung). The 'NOT correctly matched' version of this pair is almost too easy to write.

- The nationwide HPV vaccination campaign was launched by the Prime Minister from AJMER, Rajasthan, on 28 February 2026 — a national scheme with a Rajasthan hook, so it can be asked from either side.
- 6th Positive Indigenisation List (18 August 2026): 405 defence items, business potential about Rs 3,070 crore.
- A Ladakh sitting of the Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh High Court was regularised in August 2026.

Rules, frameworks and India's climate pledge

Below the level of statutes sit rules notified by ministries. Four sets from this window are examinable, and each creates a new authority or a new obligation.

- Online Gaming Rules, 2026 (22 April 2026) — set up an Online Gaming Authority, define online money games and require registration of e-sports.
- Telecom User Identification Rules, 2026 (21 August 2026) — mandate Aadhaar-based biometric verification of all telecom subscribers.

- *Petroleum and Natural Gas Rules, 2025* — replaced the 1959 Rules governing oilfield leases.
- *Draft SHANTI Rules, 2026 (August 2026)* — propose single composite licences for nuclear plants, following the Nuclear Energy Act.

On climate, India's updated Nationally Determined Contribution was approved by the Union Cabinet on 25 March 2026. Two numbers: a 47 per cent reduction in the emissions intensity of GDP by 2035, and 60 per cent non-fossil installed electricity capacity by 2035. NDCs are submitted under the Paris Agreement — link this straight to your environment notes.

- *Parliamentary committee themes of 2026 worth naming: cyber crimes and women's safety, oilseeds and pulses, water-efficient seeds, and artificial intelligence — the AI report recommended comprehensive AI legislation.*
- *A Joint Parliamentary Committee was constituted on the Corporate Laws (Amendment) Bill.*

Elections 2026, the global indices and the macro numbers

Five assembly elections were decided together, with counting on 4 May 2026. Learn the winner and one number for each state — that is all a one-liner needs.

Assembly election results, counted 4 May 2026

State / UT	Outcome
West Bengal	BJP 206 of 294; Trinamool Congress reduced to 81
Assam	BJP 82 of 126; Himanta Biswa Sarma continued as Chief Minister
Tamil Nadu	Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam single largest with 107 of 234
Kerala	Congress-led UDF
Puducherry	NDA; AINRC 18 of 30; N. Rangaswamy

Now the indices. RPSC has asked India's rank in the World Happiness Report in three consecutive papers. Learn the rank, the denominator and the publisher — the publisher is asked as often as the rank.

India in the global indices (latest editions as of September 2026)

Index	Publisher	India's rank
World Happiness Report 2026	UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network	116 of 147
Global Hunger Index 2025	Concern Worldwide / Welthungerhilfe	102 of 123
Human Development Index	UNDP	130 of 193
Global Innovation Index 2025	WIPO	38 of 139
Corruption Perceptions Index 2025	Transparency International	91 of 180
World Press Freedom Index 2026	Reporters Without Borders	157 of 180
Global Gender Gap Index 2025	World Economic Forum	131 of 148
Henley Passport Index 2026	Henley and Partners	81st
Global Peace Index 2026	Institute for Economics and Peace	127th

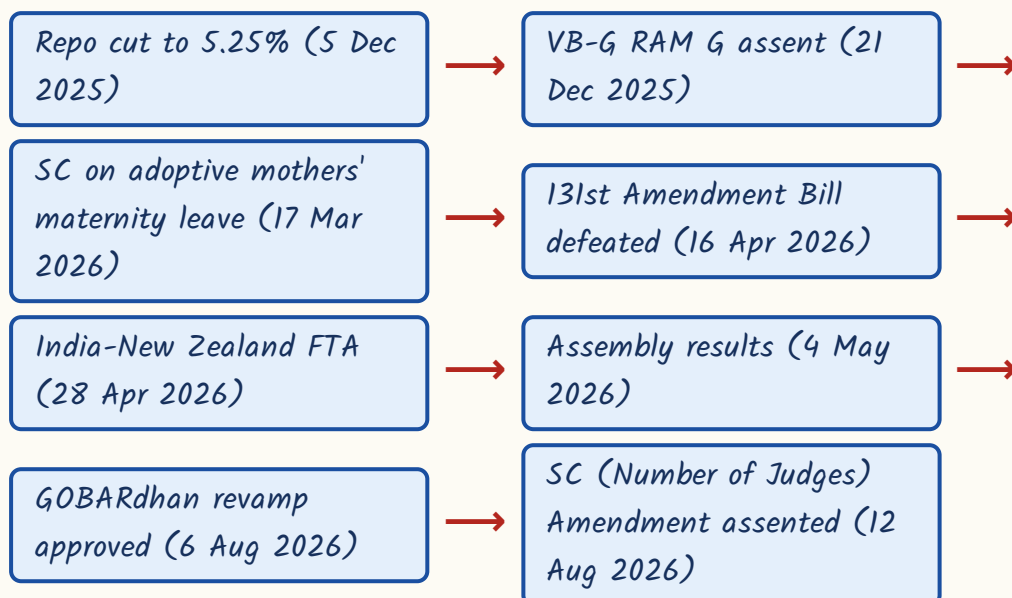
ASKED IN RAS

RESEARCH clusters 63 and 86: the World Happiness Report rank was asked in 2021, 2023 AND 2024 — three consecutive papers. Ease of Doing Business, HDI and Hunger also recur. If you learn only one index perfectly, learn Happiness: 116th of 147 in the 2026 edition.

YAAD RAKHO

Pair index with publisher using the initials: Happiness-SDSN (UN), Innovation-WIPO, Corruption-TI, Press Freedom-RSF, Gender Gap-WEF, Passport-Henley. Rank questions change every year; publisher questions never do.

- RBI cut the repo rate to 5.25 per cent on 5 December 2025 (from 5.5 per cent) and held it there through the April and August 2026 reviews.
- GDP growth in Q1 of 2026-27 was 7.8 per cent.
- Trade agreements: India-Oman CEPA (December 2025); India-New Zealand FTA signed 28 April 2026; India-Canada CEPA terms of reference signed 2 March 2026.

Chronology RPSC can ask in order**REVISION RECAP**

1. MGNREGA 2005 repealed; Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025 (VB-G RAM G) assented 21 December 2025.
2. VB-G RAM G: 125 days guaranteed, 60:40 Centre-State for general states, 90:10 for NE and Himalayan states, up to 60 days of farm-season pause.
3. Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Act, 2026 — strength 34 to 38 (37 judges besides the CJI); ordinance 17 May, LS 3 Aug, assent 12 Aug 2026.

4. Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 on delimitation — Lok Sabha 550 to 850, Census 2011 basis, women's reservation — DEFEATED 16 April 2026.
5. 84th Amendment 2001 froze seats till the first census after 2026; 106th Amendment 2023 (women's reservation) awaits census and delimitation.
6. Census 2027: first digital census, Phase I houselisting Apr-Sept 2026, Phase II population enumeration Feb 2027, census moment 00:00 hrs 1 March 2027.
7. Snow-bound areas: enumeration September 2026, reference moment 1 October 2026. Caste enumeration in Phase II.
8. Nuclear Energy Act 2025 replaced the Atomic Energy Act 1962 and allows private participation; Insurance FDI raised to 100 per cent.
9. Repealing and Amending Act 2025 repealed 71 laws; Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) 2026 covers 80 central Acts.
10. Tribunals Reforms 2026 creates a National Tribunals Commission; Kerala renamed 'Keralam' under Article 3 by simple majority.
11. CAPF (General Administration) 2026: 50 per cent of IG and 67 per cent of ADG posts by IPS deputation.
12. Winter Session 2025: 1-19 Dec, 15 sittings, 7 Bills passed, 2 referred (Securities Markets Code; Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan).
13. Budget Session 2026: 28 Jan-18 Apr, six Bills passed. Monsoon Session 2026: 20 Jul-13 Aug, 11 of 12 Bills passed.
14. SC 17 Mar 2026 — adoptive mothers get 12 weeks' paid maternity leave; SC 24 Mar 2026 — SC status only for Hinduism, Sikhism, Buddhism.
15. SC 30 Dec 2025 — 100-metre Aravalli criterion suspended, expert committee for Rajasthan, Haryana and Delhi-NCR.
16. BHAVYA Rasayan = 3 chemical parks, Rs 3,030 crore; GOBARdhan = compressed biogas, Rs 23,731 crore to 2035-36.
17. Jal Jeevan Mission extended to December 2028 (about Rs 8.7 lakh crore); PMGSY-III to March 2028 (Rs 83,977 crore).
18. Updated NDC (25 Mar 2026): 47 per cent cut in emissions intensity of GDP and 60 per cent non-fossil capacity, both by 2035.
19. Assembly results 4 May 2026: BJP 206/294 in West Bengal, BJP 82/126 in Assam, TVK largest in Tamil Nadu, UDF in Kerala, NDA in Puducherry.
20. Index ranks as of September 2026: Happiness 116/147, Hunger 102/123, HDI 130/193, Innovation 38/139, Corruption 91/180, Press Freedom 157/180.